



Photo: NRC/ Alvilda Stromme

Abdullah Mohammed (5) lives in Djibouti's Merkazi refugee camp in Obock. His family crossed the Red Sea from Yemen into Djibouti to save themselves from airstrikes. He likes to play football.

DJIBOUTI | Support to refugees and vulnerable host communities

NRC implemented a range of activities throughout 2016 in the Ali Adde, Holl Holl, and Markazi refugee settlements in Djibouti. The activities were mainly in the sectors of water, sanitation, hygiene, shelter and livelihoods support to vulnerable refugees. Our programmes helped 22,500 people.

Following recent unrest in Ethiopia, and the influx of Ethiopian refugees into Djibouti in late 2016, NRC mobilised resources and responded by implementing emergency sanitation and hygiene and shelter for new arrivals. Up to 4,000 people received assistance in Ali Addeh and Holl Holl camps.

Throughout 2016, NRC was a key player in coordination forums in Djibouti. We played a key role in bringing together actors to plan and implement a response to the influx of new arrivals from Ethiopia. NRC worked alongside UNHCR and the government agency in charge of refugee protection, ONARS, through regular coordination meetings to ensure an effective response.

Although funding in Djibouti for humanitarian response continued to be challenging, NRC was a key partner for UNHCR who funded the largest part of our activities.

Halimo (36) is a mother of four boys. She lives in Ali Adde refugee camp of Djibouti. She left Somalia during the height of deadly armed conflict in 1991. But she still hopes to return back to Somalia one day. "Every refugee dreams of going back home," she says.



Photo:

HELPING OTHERS IN TIMES OF NEED



I never thought in my life that I would be living in the hottest place on earth”, says Loza. “We live in a small shelter in the sweltering heat and at the beginning we were in need of everything.”

“Living in Djibouti’s Markazi refugee camps was never in my plan. All I ever wanted was to complete my studies in Yemen and create my own business”, says 17-year-old Loza Yahya.

Forced to flee the civil war and violence in her country, Loza and her family of five, arrived in Obock in April 2015. Before coming to Obock Loza and her family had enjoyed a decent life in Sana’a capital.

Loza was a student at Al Mouch-tamaa secondary school. She dreamt of becoming an independent woman and a doctor or creating her own business to support her widowed mother and her community.

The first challenge they faced was the contrast of the two environments, Obock was arid and very hot, while Sana’a was a cold city with many facilities.

In addition, there was lack of adequate shelter to protect from the hot sun and dust storms during the hot season.

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Despite daily challenges, Loza is one of NRC’s hygiene promoters in Markazi. She has gained hygiene skills from training organised by NRC. Loza is involved in public sensitisation and delivery of hygiene promotion messages on jerrican cleaning, hand washing and waste management. Her smile continues to inspire many people in the Markazi refugee camp.



Young Yemeni refugees who fled Yemen crisis carrying food ration during a food distribution at Merkazi refugee camp.